Future Features — Salah Tracker

Researched and compiled: 2026-10-18. Updated: 2026-10-20 — prayer-time accuracy (section 3A) shipped.

Ideas for Salah Tracker's next features. The document covers: - how the app compares with other prayer and habit apps - what users complain about in those apps - features others have that we lack - new ideas no competitor offers - a phased roadmap

How to read this: - Competitor features come from public app store listings, developer sites and review roundups. The developers describe these features themselves; they weren't checked by installing the apps. - Effort estimates are rough, for one developer: - **S**: a few days - **M**: one to two weeks - **L**: several weeks, or it needs a backend - **Fit** means how much existing code a feature can reuse.

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1. Where Salah Tracker stands today

This was checked against the code, not taken from memory.

Area	What exists	Gap found in the code
Prayer times	Calculated on the phone with `adhan-kotlin` (`com.batoulapps.adhan:adhan2`) — the AlAdhan network call is gone. 23 calculation methods, a school-of-thought setting (Standard/Hanafi/**Ja'fari**), a high-latitude rule, per-prayer minute offsets, and Jumu'ah awareness (Friday Dhuhr is labelled and can be treated separately).	None of the coordinates leave the device anymore. Ja'fari (Shia) users get Zuhrain/Maghribain labelling and matching Asr/Isha times — this goes beyond what any competitor reviewed offers (see 2.2).
Prayer logging	The 5 obligatory prayers, logged as `CONGREGATION`, `INDIVIDUAL`, `QAZA_PENDING`, `QAZA_COMPLETED`, `MENSTRUATION` or `NOT_RECORDED`. Bulk update for catching up on history.	There are no sunnah or voluntary prayers. There's no on-time vs. late distinction, because `updatedAt` changes on every edit. Jumu'ah has no special handling.
Qaza	A backlog dashboard and per-prayer pending counts (`QazaBalanceEntity`).	There's no calculator for estimating years of missed prayers, and no make-up plan or projection.
Goals	Categories `SALAT`, `QURAN`, `FASTING`, `CHARITY` and `DHIKR`. Goals are daily, weekly or monthly, with numeric check-ins.	These are generic counters. There's no dedicated tasbih counter, fasting log or khatam planner.
Stats	Vico charts and a per-prayer breakdown.	There's no year-long heatmap and no badges.
Calendar	Shows Hijri dates through the `HijriDate` util.	The Hijri date isn't used for any reminders yet.
Reminders	A device sound, snooze, full-screen alert and vibration.	There's no bundled azan audio, and no Friday or sunnah reminders.
Mosque Mode	Geofenced auto-vibrate, nearby search through OpenStreetMap, background location.	Unique in the market. It isn't connected to prayer logging yet.

Area	What exists	Gap found in the code
Content	A verse of the day from the Quran.com API.	There's no hadith, dua or adhkar content, and no full Quran reader.
Platform	Google Drive backup. English, Arabic, French and Urdu, with right-to-left layout for Arabic and Urdu. Dark mode. Donate and Developers screens.	There's no widget, no Wear OS app and no Qibla compass.

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2. Competitor landscape

2.1 Apps reviewed

App	Highlights
Muslim Pro	Market leader. Azan with several muezzin voices, full Quran, Qibla, tasbih, Hijri calendar, duas, 99 Names, community features. Ad-supported, with a premium tier.
Pillars	Privacy-first, no ads, minimal permissions.
Al Taqweem	Free and ad-free. Full Quran, Qibla compass, tasbih.
PrayPath	Offline Qibla, 12-month streak heatmap, tasbih.
A Simple Salah	Streaks with grace days, home-screen and lock-screen widgets, works offline.
Prayer Tracker & Daily Hadith	Streaks, 9 badges, Qibla, widget, daily hadith.
Salat Now	Tasbih with goals, Qibla with haptic feedback.
Salah Tracker: Namaz & Qibla	Qibla, Quran, tasbih, habit streaks. Has a name very close to ours.
Prayer Pause	Prayer times, Qibla, focus mode that silences or blocks the phone, on-time vs. late streaks (premium).
My Sujoods	Consistency charts, heatmaps, qaza calculator and tracking.
FivePrayer / Khushu / DeenFocus	Lock or block the phone during prayer time.
Mizan / HalalYouNeed / Everyday Muslim	Private prayer groups, family leaderboards, shared progress.
Muslim Habits Tracker / Niyyah / Muslim Daily	Track sunnah rawatib, witr, tahajjud, duha, fasting and adhkar.
rakaah.ai / Sahw / 2026 Sujood App	Count rak'ahs with sensors on Apple Watch or iPhone.
Tanwir / Niyat / Ask Quran / Quran Study	AI chat companions for questions about Islam.
Tarteel	AI feedback on Quran recitation and memorisation.

2.2 Where Salah Tracker is already ahead

- **Mosque Mode.** It switches the ringer automatically near saved mosques, using geofences. None of the apps reviewed do this.
- **Qaza bulk update.** It catches up historical logs more thoroughly than most trackers do.
- **Right-to-left support for both Arabic *and* Urdu**, alongside English and French.
- **No ads, no subscription, no account.** The Donate and Contribute screens are open and direct. Most competitors rely on ads or paywalls.

- **On-device prayer-time calculation.** No coordinates sent anywhere — this is the privacy opening from 2.3 and N7, and it's already shipped, not a plan.
- **Ja'fari (Shia) school of thought.** Asr follows Dhuhr ("Zuhrain") and Isha follows Maghrib ("Maghribain"), with matching labels and times, while all 5 prayers stay independently tracked. No app reviewed in section 2.1 offers this — most of the market treats "Asr school" as a two-way Hanafi/Shafi'i choice and stops there.

2.3 What users complain about, and the opening for us

1. **Ads in a religious app.** Users report full-screen video ads around the adhan and banners next to Quran verses. - Our opening: we have no ads. Say so in the store listing.
2. **Privacy of location data.** - Muslim Pro was widely reported in 2020 to have passed location data to a data broker (X-Mode). - Pillars wins users by avoiding data collection altogether. - Our opening: calculate times on the device and keep data local.
3. **Inaccurate times that can't be corrected.** Users want the right method, the right Asr school and small manual adjustments. - Our opening: the accuracy settings in section 3A.
4. **Adhan notifications silently failing on Android**, killed by battery optimisation and the phone maker's own app-killers. We hit this ourselves while debugging Mosque Mode on a Samsung phone. - Our opening: a notification health check (idea N8).
5. **Religious content behind a paywall.** - Our opening: stay free, funded by donations.

2.4 Market trends

Trend	Examples	What it means for us
Focus mode during prayer	FivePrayer, Khushu, Prayer Pause, DeenFocus	**High.** We already control the ringer. Don't use the Accessibility API to block apps: Google Play restricts that use, so it's a rejection risk.
Social and family accountability	Mizan, HalalYouNeed, Everyday Muslim, Sunnah Way	**Medium.** It needs a backend and careful handling of children's data.
Fuller habit tracking	Muslim Habits Tracker, Niyyah, Muslim Daily, Sunnah Helper	**High.** Tracking is our core strength.
AI companions	Tanwir, Niyat, Ask Quran, Mufti AI	**Low, and risky.** AI answers to fiqh (Islamic law) questions are a reputational risk.
Sensor-based rak'ah counting	rakaah.ai, Sahw, 2026 Sujood App	**Medium.** No Wear OS equivalent turned up, so this is an open gap on Android.
Ramadan features	RafiQ, Ramadan & Quran Tracker, Muslim & Quran	**Medium to high**, but seasonal.
Gamification	Prayer Tracker & Daily Hadith, PrayPath, A Simple Salah	**High.** We already have the data.

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3. Features others have that we lack

A. Prayer-time accuracy and reliability

All five of these shipped on 2026-10-20, together, by switching the whole prayer-time pipeline to on-device calculation.

Feature	Status	Notes
Asr school (Hanafi/Shafi'i, plus Ja'fari)	Done	Went further than planned: added a third option, Ja'fari (Shia), not just the planned Hanafi/Shafi'i toggle — see 2.2.
High-latitude adjustment	Done	An `AUTOMATIC` default (seventh-of-the-night above 48°, otherwise middle-of-the-night) plus manual override, mirroring `adhan2`'s `HighLatitudeRule`.
Per-prayer minute offsets	Done	Users can nudge any of the 5 prayer times to match their mosque's timetable.
Prayer times calculated on the phone	Done	`adhan-kotlin` (`com.batoulapps.adhan:adhan2`, pinned at `0.0.6` — `0.0.7` needs Kotlin 2.4.0 and breaks this project's Hilt annotation processor on Kotlin 2.3.0). The AlAdhan network call and `PrayerTimeCacheEntity` are gone; no coordinates leave the device.
Jumu'ah awareness	Done	Friday Dhuhr is labelled Jumu'ah wherever a single prayer is shown (Home, reminders), taking precedence over Ja'fari's Zuhrain label on that one day. No earlier Friday reminder yet — still open, see section E.

Not yet built from this section: an earlier Jumu'ah reminder specifically (the labelling is done, the extra reminder timing is not).

B. Core worship tools

Feature	Effort	Fit	Notes
Qibla compass	S–M	Strong	Uses the phone's rotation-vector sensor plus the compass bearing to the Kaaba. `GeoDistance` already does similar maths. Show a calibration hint and a warning about magnetic interference. Almost every competitor has one.
Tasbih (dhikr) counter	S	Very strong	Reaching 33 or 100 automatically checks in to the existing `DHIKR` goals.
Home-screen widget	M	Strong	A Jetpack Glance widget with the next prayer, a countdown and one-tap logging (see N2).
Azan audio	M	Medium	Bundled recitations add to the app's size and need licensing; an optional download would avoid the size cost.

Feature	Effort	Fit	Notes
Zakat calculator	S–M	Weak	Common in all-in-one Islamic apps (Muslim Pro, premium). Rules differ by school, so the wording needs care.
99 Names of Allah	S	Weak	A static content screen. Little gain beyond matching competitors.

C. Daily content

Feature	Effort	Fit	Notes
Hadith of the day	S	Strong	Reuse the verse-of-the-day pattern. `fawazahmed0/hadith-api` comes in several languages and includes authenticity grades. Show the grade with each hadith.
Morning and evening adhkar with reminders	M	Medium	**Licensing is unresolved.** No clear licence turned up for Hisnul Muslim data. Confirm a content source before building.
Full Quran reader	L	Medium	`QuranApiService` is already set up, but a good reader needs offline text, translations (often copyrighted), audio and bookmarks.

D. Deeper tracking

These build on our core strength.

Feature	Effort	Fit	Notes
Qaza estimator (years missed, or age at puberty)	S	Very strong	Writes straight into the existing qaza counts. Label the result as an estimate, since the schools count differently. Some count Witr, making 6 a day.
Sunnah and voluntary prayers (rawatib, witr, tahajjud, duha)	M	Medium	Store these in a **separate table**, so streaks, day colours, qaza and backup stay unchanged. Needs a database migration and a backup format update.
On-time vs. late	M	Medium	Needs a `loggedAt` timestamp, or simply ask the user. Gives stats like "92% of Fajr on time."

Feature	Effort	Fit	Notes
Fasting log (Ramadan, sunnah fasts, missed fasts to make up)	M	Medium	Builds on the existing `FASTING` goal category. Missed Ramadan fasts would work like qaza prayers.
Yearly heatmap	S	Strong	A GitHub-style grid of each day's result, built from data that already exists.
Badges	S–M	Strong	Worked out from existing streaks and stats, for example "40 days of Fajr in congregation." Keep the tone modest.
Streak grace days	S	Strong	Missing one day doesn't reset the streak. This stops users giving up after a single slip.

E. Seasonal and recurring reminders

These are cheap to build because the app already converts dates to Hijri.

Feature	Effort	Notes
Sunnah fasting reminders	S	Monday/Thursday, the 13th–15th of each Hijri month (Ayyam al-Bid), Arafah and Ashura. **Skip** Eid and 11th–13th Dhul-Hijjah (the Days of Tashreeq), and don't single out Fridays. Merge overlapping days into one reminder.
Friday reminders	S	Surah al-Kahf, salawat (blessings on the Prophet), and the hour of dua on Friday afternoon.
Ramadan mode	M	Suhoor and iftar countdowns, a fasting log, one-tap taraweeh logging, and a khatam planner (a target number of juz per day).
Last ten nights of Ramadan	S	Reminders on the odd nights, for Laylat al-Qadr.

F. Social

Feature	Effort	Notes
Private accountability groups	L	Needs a backend, which we don't have. Only share "prayed / not prayed," and only by choice, to protect privacy.
Family or kids mode	L	Google Play's Families policy and children's privacy laws apply. A lighter option: profiles kept only on the phone.

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4. New ideas: what no competitor reviewed offers

These build on what only Salah Tracker has, mainly Mosque Mode and its ringer and geofence code.

N1. Mosque check-in that logs congregation automatically top pick

- **What it does:** when Mosque Mode registers a dwell inside a saved mosque during a prayer window, a notification asks "Prayed Asr in congregation at Masjid Al-Noor?" One tap logs `CONGREGATION`.
- **Extra stats:** congregational prayers this month, broken down per mosque.
- **Why it's new:** no app reviewed links mosque presence to prayer logging, and we already have both halves.
- **Effort:** M.
- **Conditions:**
- The user always confirms; just being near a mosque never logs a prayer.
- The new use of location must go into the Google Play location declaration and the in-app disclosure text.

N2. Widget with one-tap logging

- **What it does:** shows the next prayer and a countdown, with buttons to log the current prayer from the home screen.
- **Why it's new:** other apps' widgets only *display* times. For a tracker, fewer taps means more logging and better retention.
- **Effort:** M.

N3. Qaza make-up planner

- **What it does:** combines the qaza estimator with a plan and a projected finish date. For example: "1 qaza with each prayer clears 2,340 Fajr in about 6.4 years. 2 per prayer takes about 3.2 years."
- **Reminder:** after each prayer, an optional "Add a qaza Fajr now?" notification.
- **Why it's new:** competitors stop at the calculator.
- **Effort:** S–M.

N4. Prayer quiet window

- **What it does:** switches the phone to vibrate for N minutes from each adhan, wherever the user is, then restores the sound. This is Mosque Mode's ringer logic triggered by time instead of location.
- **Permissions:** vibrate needs no Do Not Disturb access.
- **Why it matters:** Prayer Pause sells this as a premium feature on iOS. We can offer it free on Android, without app-blocking hacks.
- **Effort:** S–M.

N5. Travel (musafir) mode

- **What it does:** notices when the user is more than about 80 km from their saved home. Sources give anywhere from 80 to 90 km.
- **Then it:**
- suggests shortening the four-rak'ah prayers (qasr)
- shows options for combining prayers according to the user's school. The default Hanafi position is no combining.
- **Why it's new:** this turned up only as a user feature request and in academic prototypes.
- **Effort:** M.

- **Needs:** careful wording that offers guidance rather than rulings. The school-of-thought (`Madhab`) setting this originally called for is now in place (Standard/Hanafi/Ja'fari), so this can key combining rules off it directly.

N6. Wear OS app

- **What it does:**
- a watch tile showing the next prayer
- a vibration on the wrist at adhan time
- one-tap logging from the watch
- **Later:** a rak'ah counter using the watch's motion sensor.
- **Why it's new:** every sensor-based rak'ah counter found is Apple-only.
- **Effort:** L.

N7. Privacy-first, and saying so

- **What it is:**
- prayer times calculated on the phone — done (2026-10-20)
- no ads, no accounts, no analytics
- data kept on the phone, backed up only to the user's own Google Drive
- **How to show it:** a short "Your data" page in Settings, a clean Data safety section on Google Play, and privacy as a headline in the store description. **Still open** — on-device calculation is in, but nothing surfaces it to the user yet.
- **Why it matters:** it answers the market's second-loudest complaint.
- **Effort:** S — the hard dependency (on-device calculation) is already done.

N8. Notification health check

- **What it does:** a Settings screen that checks what silently breaks adhans on Android. Each item gets a "Fix" button that opens the right system screen.
- **What it checks:**
- notifications or notification channels switched off
- exact-alarm permission
- battery optimisation
- Samsung's "Sleeping apps" list and its equivalents on other brands
- background location for Mosque Mode
- **Why it matters:** it answers a top Android complaint, and we learned these failures first-hand while debugging Mosque Mode.
- **Effort:** S–M.

N9. Iqamah times per mosque

- **What it does:** users enter each saved mosque's iqamah (jamaat) times. Reminders then say "Iqamah at Masjid Al-Noor in 15 min."
- **Why it matters:** in South Asia, our Urdu audience, iqamah often runs well after the adhan, and it's what people plan around.
- **Effort:** S–M.
- **Later:** importing timetables from mosque platforms. Check their API terms first.

N10. Khushu journal

- **What it does:** an optional one-line note or focus rating after each logged prayer.
- **Extra stats:** for example, "You rated Fajr 'focused' 70% of the time."
- **No AI needed**, so there's no risk of AI answering fiqh questions.
- **Effort:** S–M.

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5. Roadmap

Phase 1: quick wins

Small effort and high impact. Most of it reuses existing code. 1. ~~Asr school, high-latitude rule and per-prayer offsets~~ — done 2026-10-20, together with on-device calculation (originally Phase 3) 2. Qibla compass 3. Tasbih counter that checks in to `DHIKR` goals 4. Qaza estimator that fills `QazaBalanceEntity` 5. Sunnah fasting and Friday reminders, based on Hijri dates 6. Notification health check (N8) 7. Privacy page surfacing the on-device calculation switch (N7) — now cheap since the switch itself is done

Phase 2: features that set us apart

1. Mosque check-in that logs congregation (N1)
2. Widget with one-tap logging (N2)
3. Qaza make-up planner (N3)
4. Prayer quiet window (N4)
5. Hadith of the day
6. Yearly heatmap and streak grace days

Phase 3: bigger investments

1. ~~Prayer times calculated on the phone~~ — done 2026-10-20; the privacy page itself (N7) moved to Phase 1
2. Sunnah and voluntary prayer tracking
3. On-time vs. late logging
4. Ramadan mode
5. Travel mode (N5) — now has a real madhhab setting to key off (`Madhab`), which this item originally called out as a prerequisite
6. Badges

Phase 4: evaluate before committing

- Wear OS app (N6)
- Full Quran reader
- Bundled azan audio
- Social groups and family mode (need a backend and children's privacy compliance)
- Any AI feature. Never use AI to answer fiqh questions.

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6. Risks and policy notes

- **Google Play location declaration.** Every new use of background location (N1, N5) must go into the Play Console location declaration and the in-app disclosure. Today these only cover ringer switching.

- **Accessibility API.** Don't use it to block apps during prayer. Google Play restricts it to genuine accessibility uses.
- **Children's data.** A family or kids mode brings in Google Play's Families policy and children's privacy laws.
- **Content licences:**
- Most Quran translations are copyrighted.
- hadith-api is free to reuse (Unlicense).
- No licence was found for Hisnul Muslim data.
- Azan recordings need the rights-holder's permission.
- **Differences between schools of thought (madhhabs).** They differ on Asr time, combining prayers, how qaza is counted and whether Witr is included. Offer settings, use neutral wording, cite sources, and never present results as rulings. Asr timing and prayer-combining (Ja'fari's Zuhrain/Maghribain) are handled this way already, via the `Madhab` setting; qaza counting and Witr inclusion are still open, and matter most for N3 and the fasting/Ramadan work in Phase 3.
- **Exact alarms.** Android 12+ restricts them. The notification health check should cover this permission.

Sources

Competitor apps - Muslim Pro - Prayer Pause - PrayPath - Al Taqweem - My Sujoods - Prayer Tracker & Daily Hadith - Prayer Times & Qibla Tracker - Salat Now - A Simple Salah - Salah Tracker: Namaz & Qibla - Pillars

Privacy, ads and user complaints - Comparitech: Muslim prayer app privacy study - Unstar: prayer apps ranked 2026 - FivePrayer: Muslim Pro alternatives - FivePrayer: privacy-focused Muslim apps - Islamtics: best Islamic apps for Android 2026

Focus mode - FivePrayer - FivePrayer: lock phone for prayer - Khushu

Social and family - Mizan - HalalYouNeed - Salah Tracker for Kids

Sensors and wearables - rakaah.ai - Prayer Memory - Sahw - 2026 Sujood App

Habit and sunnah tracking - Muslim Habits Tracker - Niyyah - Muslim Daily - Sunnah Helper - Everyday Muslim - Sunnah Way

Qaza calculators - Qadaa Prayer Calculator - Salah Journal - Qada Mate - I.M.A.M. on years of missed prayers

Travel - GoSolat musafir mode request - FivePrayer: jamak and qasar - e-Pocket Musafir paper - IslamQA: combining prayers for travellers (Hanafi)

Ramadan and fasting - RafiQ - Ramadan & Quran Tracker - Muslim & Quran - TechCabal: Ramadan apps 2026 - Al Hakam: days of voluntary fasting - Sahih Muslim 1162

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Libraries and data - adhan-kotlin - hadith-api - dua-dhikr API - House of Islam developer datasets